



2025 EFFIE COLLEGIATE US COMPETITION

Amazon Challenge | Entry Status Notification
Northwestern University
Entry ID# E-839-742

Dear Team,

On behalf of the Effie LIONS Foundation, thank you for your participation in the Spring semester of the 2025 Effie Collegiate US competition. We appreciate your hard work to develop a solution to Amazon's marketing challenge. We are pleased to share that your entry, "Your Prime, Your Way", has been selected to advance in the competition as a [semi-finalist](#).

Your entry will be reviewed by the Amazon brand team to narrow down the top two teams that will be invited to pitch their ideas in person. Semi-finalist teams will learn if their work is advancing as a finalist in the upcoming days.

Finalist presentations will be May 19th & 20th at the Amazon brand headquarters in Seattle, Washington. Please save these dates. Travel and lodging expenses for students will be covered by Amazon.

We welcome your feedback on how to improve the program and entry process. This includes suggestions for additional resources, clarification on requirements, timing, and anything else you think would be helpful. Please feel free to share your thoughts anonymously [here](#) or email your feedback to collegiate@effie.org.

Thanks again for your participation.

Cordially,
Tiffani Gautier
Head of Program Delivery
Effie LIONS Foundation

JURY FEEDBACK

Because the judges have diverse disciplines and experience, you will notice that their points of view may vary.

STRONGEST ELEMENTS

- 👉 1. Insight / Single Minded Proposition. You proved why algorithm frustration is a very real thing AND an effective springboard for creative. High praise to the use of survey data to bear that out.
- 2. Execution. The campaign go-to-market plan was well supported and the case making was very strong. In particular, the details supporting channel selection and channel strategy are robust and well thought through.
- 3. Measurement approach. Appreciated the rigor applied and exercise in exposing the target audience to your creative examples for directional findings.
- 👉 Incredible work across the board! I loved how deeply you dove into your data sources. You clearly took the time to understand your user on a meaningful level.

Your KPIs were realistic and well thought-out, clearly informed by your research. I also really appreciated how specific you were about when and why to use qualitative vs. quantitative data.

The table in Section 3 was fantastic. I love the attention to detail and a clear plan that brought your ideas to life in a tangible, actionable way. So, so good!

Also, huge kudos for using the Prime brand colors and logo thoughtfully, and for writing REAL copy for the ads. That level of craft and care makes a big difference here. Excellent job!

- 👉 It is very clear how the execution ties back to the insights and how the insight was crafted by well researched context. The channel mix for the execution is also one of the stronger examples I've reviewed taking channel context and behaviors and implementing them into the creative strategy.
- 👉 Overall, a very strong campaign and can be scaled easily, which delivers on the brief. Great creative that makes you laugh, which already helps with brand impression and perception.
- 👉 Reclaiming yourself... stop being like your parents and strategy. Well done.
- 👉 Great support with clear data that is easy to understand and read.
- 👉 Research that uncovered Amazon sentiments among GenZ as a tool & how to convert that insight into action and conversion to subscriptions.

- Research points are strong, the word cloud and dashboards reinforce the points very well.
- Insight regarding privacy is tied to the benefit of subscribing & why passively accepting whatever the algorithm serves is not fully developing yourself as Gen Z since your world is curated based on the subscribers' habits, not yours.
- The campaign gives you a reason why to buy & what the user will get from it. The creative execution hits on the reality of the human truth.

Media partners connected to the insight of personalization, for example Spotify showed users the song they want instead of their sibling's choices.

- Measurement is conservative and that is good.
- This was an extremely thorough campaign. Very well researched and organized. You targeted an issue and enemy with the algorithm that was really smart and targeting creative at the placements along the way was smart as well. Contextual media was smart.
- I really, really like the insight around gen z not wanting to be dictated to by algorithms. (next time jump into the feeling...remember the insight and strategic approach are for a creative team to create an execution with. Give them an emotion and they'll give you creative with emotional output).
- Really appreciated how thoughtful this team was in outlining each campaign touchpoint, how it connected to the audience, and why it works. The rationale for placing each relevant ad on the channels & touchpoints where users would be experiencing this friction to potentially lead them to purchase their own subscription was really smart as well.
- Very strong media, channel and comms strategy with a well broken-down budget. Very, thorough and well organized overall. There was a clear tension in the insight, and the strategy exploits that insight in a clear and focused all while bringing everything to life through a strong comms, media and measurement recommendations.
- - Data, data, data! Team did an excellent job proving out every decision they made.
- - Great way showing, rather than just telling, why they need a personal account
- - Smart use of media, using different placement to really intercept contextual moments where the message could be understood
- I see the "red thread" – insight, strategy, what the execution needs to do. It addresses the need for change and points the service towards a real, solvable problem for all parties.
- Strong measurement thought process - loved the combination of true market research and listening combined to tell a story of growth. Amazon is a utility brand to this cohort (and

others actually) - so calling this out was smart. As was the insight of control being a top priority for Gen Z.

- The research supporting the framing and strategy is very thorough and provides a great foundation for the idea. The channel mix makes a ton of sense in the context of the campaign, and to round things out, the measurement framework provides a detailed and relevant set of metrics that provide a meaningful view of performance. Love the addition of A/B testing to the mix, too!
- Really good execution with a good level of humor and smart contextual media placement. Great job tapping into relevant situations and making the algorithm the enemy and triggering emotional response to the ads - they will be quite likely to make people consider their own Prime account.

OPPORTUNITIES FOR IMPROVEMENT

- Quick note 1: When proving out a point, a "hypothetical" sales chart needs more context and a true role in the case making.

Quick note 2: When thinking about the media plan, I was surprised that budget costs didn't feature in the calculus. It's understood that Amazon has deep pockets, but discussion or rationale around cost will need to be factored and delivered into the media mix decisions and recommendations.

- Your reel has a solid foundation, but there's room to make it more succinct, snappy, and attention-grabbing. Focus on pacing, keep the energy up and make every second count. This is your pitch moment, so lean into selling the big idea with clarity and confidence. Great start just needs some refinement to fully land the impact.
- The measurement section is very strong, but it would benefit from a deeper dive into sales performance. It is present and well written. However, it goes deeper on sentiment vs performance.
- "Gen Z's struggle for autonomy in a digital landscape that's supposedly built for them" & this right here is your insight. Your insight felt a bit like a repeat of your target audience insight verses a separate campaign insight. It was in there but that should have been the first statement.
- The name of the campaign could be as creative as the overall strategy. Such a great concept and approach for a boring campaign name "Amazon Prime your way".
- I am not convinced this is a true issue that needs to be solved. Don't different "users" within one account solve for this issue already?
- Create an audience persona that further illustrates the target.

- I think it could have been more streamlined in the strategy and messaging. even though it was very thorough and appreciated, it could be a little more concise because the message was strong enough.
- Measurements, measurements, measurements! Always list actual numbers and benchmarks for KPI's. Even if they are hypothetical, numbers show you have an idea of where you want to go (even if you're not super confident you can get there).
- This submission is really strong I just caution this team to be careful when approaching their measurement section to ensure the behavioral and perception shifts are feasible within the confines of Amazon's product capabilities around personalization. This way they can set themselves up for success better tied to areas within their control within the campaign.
- While the entry was very thorough. I would challenge them to focus their ideas more. Try to get to the point sooner, especially in the insight section. Get to a super simple core insight that leads directly into a simple, prescriptive and direct strategy line.
- Write ups are a little long and there is opportunity to edit while also not losing the crux of the information.
- There may be a need to address Amazon Prime's space in these types of conversations. This could be a hurdle, but one that is worth risking if the hurdle can be cleared. Spoiler alert: the hurdle can be cleared.
- Tighten the strategy so it has a bit more longevity. It feels slightly like a campaign versus a platform, with that being said, I still think it is very strong!
- Being a little more explicit in calling out the strategic through-line across the creative and measurement elements of the campaign would be helpful; it is implicit in what you're doing, but it's always better to be more upfront with it—keep reinforcing the strategic rationale that is driving the work at every opportunity.
- Parts of the strategy don't read as a single thought. e.g. 66% of respondent cite privacy as the key concern, yet you lead into control as the key benefit.

Also, I'd challenge the notion that people are valuing self-expression over utility.

As said, it all comes together in the execution, but you might want to sharpen the strategy.

OVERALL FEEDBACK

- The strategic idea and media plan could be incredibly effective if executed. It's a strong insight with a compelling hook for creatives.

- It's extremely well written, actionable, and incredibly unique.
- Well researched, delivers on the brief, and smart creative.
- Need to understand that this is a real problem to solve.
- The approach gives you a reason to buy a sub. The 'enemy' of the algorithm is relatable to the audience and a driving motivation.
- There is a lot of sharp thinking and smooth creative in this. This group understood finding the human problem that exists for the audience i.e. overwhelmed by algorithms. The creative then respects the tension of not having your own prime account and why you need to have it.
- The thinking was really smart, and the matrixed media plan really showed how thorough this team was throughout every piece of this entry.
- It's a very well-organized case that answers the brief in a compelling and unique way.
- Overall great entry. It really hits on the brief while proving out all their choices.
- Smartly written and the creative was executed very well. It seems like this would be picked up by a client for sure.
- This is a solid campaign with a well-reasoned strategic basis informing a strong series of activations.

NOTE: Per the confidentiality requirements outlined in your signed Non-Disclosure Agreement and consent of the Release & Liability Waiver, all participants must refrain from publicly publishing any elements of your 2025 Effie Collegiate US x Amazon Brand Challenge submission. We must ensure that no information from the client brief is included in your reel, prior to publishing. If you would like to include competition elements of your submission in your online portfolio or share with a potential employer, contact collegiate@effie.org for approval.